

The Grief Workbook - Printable Worksheets

Every worksheet from the book, one per page. Print as many copies as you need.

The Riding Card

Name it: this is a grief wave; it is about _____; it will pass.

Feet flat. In for four, out for six, five times.

Let it. Do not fight it; do not feed it.

Five things I can see, four I can hear, three I can touch, two I can smell, one I can taste.

The next small thing: pay, walk to the car, put the kettle on.

Tonight: the log. Waves that are written down come back smaller.

The Bad-Day Card

This is a wave, not a verdict. It is about _____. It will pass.

Feet on the floor. Four in, six out, five times.

The next small thing: _____

Today I will still: get up, eat, go outside, tell _____

I do not decide anything big today.

If I have thoughts of not wanting to be here, I call _____ (988 / 116 123 / my doctor) today.

Tonight: the log. Tomorrow: the ritual, or a pleasure from the list.

Worksheet 3.1 - Where I am

Who died, and when	
How (expected, sudden, after a long illness, other)	
What we were to each other, in a sentence	
How my days look now, in three lines	
What I am doing that helps	
What I am doing that does not	
Who I have talked to about it, honestly, in the last two weeks	
What I most want from these eight weeks	

Worksheet 3.2 - The grief self-check

Rate each line for the last two weeks: 0 not at all, 1 sometimes, 2 often, 3 nearly always.

	0-3
Longing or yearning for the person that is hard to bear	
Preoccupied with them, or with how they died, most of the day	
Feeling that part of me died with them	
Disbelief that they are really gone	
Avoiding places, people or things that remind me, because it is too much	
Intense emotional pain (sorrow, anger, guilt, bitterness) about the death	
Difficulty going on with life: friends, interests, plans	
Feeling numb, or that life is meaningless without them	
Loneliness that is about them specifically	
Trouble trusting or caring about other people since	
Total (0-30)	

This is not a diagnosis. In the first months, high scores are ordinary grief. If the total is still 15 or above at twelve months after the death, and the lines are true nearly every day, that is the pattern the clinicians call prolonged grief (Chapter 11), and the middle weeks of the program, or a grief therapist, are for you. Score it again at the end of Week 8 and at three months.

Worksheet 3.3 - The basics check

	Yes / No / Sometimes
Sleeping at least five or six hours most nights	
Eating at least two meals a day	
Out of the house, on foot, most days	
One conversation with another person most days	
Drinking within the usual limits, and not to sleep	
Taking my medicines	
Any thoughts of not wanting to be here (if yes, Chapter 12 today)	

Worksheet 1.1 - The grief log, Week 1

Day	Heaviest moment (0-10)	The feeling (one or two words)	What set it off	What helped, if anything	Sleep (hours)
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Worksheet 1.2 - The basics, Week 1

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Up by _____ and in bed by _____							
Two meals							
Twenty minutes outside on foot							
One real conversation							
No alcohol to sleep							

Weekly review

Grief log completed on how many days	
The average heaviest moment (0-10)	
The feeling that came up most	
The triggers I can already see	
The one thing that helped most	
Basics: which ones I managed most days, and which I did not	
Ready for Week 2? (the log done at least five days)	

Worksheet 2.1 - The trigger map

Predictable triggers (dates, places, times, tasks)	What happens	What I could plan around it

Ambush triggers (songs, smells, sights, phrases)	What happens	The riding routine, and then

Worksheet 2.2 - Riding a wave: the two-minute routine

Copy this to a card for a pocket or a phone.

1. Name it	"This is a grief wave. It is about _____. It will pass."
2. Feet and breath	Feet flat on the floor; breathe in for four, out for six, five times.
3. Let it	Do not fight it and do not feed it. If tears come, let them; if not, fine.
4. Five things	Five things I can see, four I can hear, three I can touch, two I can smell, one I can taste.
5. Next small thing	The next physical thing to do: pay, walk to the car, put the kettle on.
6. Later	Write it on the log tonight. Waves that are written down come back smaller.

Worksheet 2.3 - The avoided list

Places, people, objects, activities, conversations and subjects I have been steering around since the death, and how much each one frightens me (0 to 10).

Avoided	Since when	Fear (0-10)	What I am afraid will happen

Weekly review

Average heaviest moment this week (0-10), against Week 1	
The three biggest predictable triggers	
Did the two planned grief times happen? What were they like?	
Did I use the riding routine? Did it help?	
The avoided list: how many items, and the three lowest-fear ones	
Basics this week	
Ready for Week 3? (Week 3 is the story; if this week was very hard, do Week 2 again)	

Worksheet 3.1 - The story of the loss

Sitting	Date	Distress before (0-10)	Distress after (0-10)	Where I got to
1				
2				
3				
4				

Write in the journal, or here:

[illegible]

Worksheet 3.2 - The parts I have never said

After the fourth sitting: the moments in the story that I skipped, softened, or have never told anyone, and who I could tell one of them to.

The part	Why I have not said it	Who could hear it

Weekly review

Sittings completed	
Distress before and after, first sitting and fourth	
The part that was hardest to write	
The part I had never said, and whether I said it to anyone	
Sleep this week, against Week 1	
What I did after each sitting to come back	
Ready for Week 4? (the story told through to the end at least once)	

Worksheet 4.1 - The balanced view

The thought that hurts	Guilt / anger / if-only / other	How much I believe it (0-100)	Evidence for (facts; what I knew then)	Evidence against; what I would tell a friend	The balanced view	Belief now (0-100)

Worksheet 4.2 - The unfinished conversation

The letter (what I never said, or need to say again):

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

The reply (in their voice, as honestly as I can imagine it):

[illegible]

Worksheet 4.3 - The first avoided item

The item (lowest fear from Worksheet 2.3)	Fear before (0- 10)	What I did	Fear at the peak	Fear after	What actually happened

Weekly review

The thoughts I found in the story, and the two or three I worked on	
Belief in the worst one, before and after	
The letter: written? The reply: written? What the reply said	
The avoided item: done? What happened against what I feared	
Average heaviest moment this week, against Week 1	
Basics	
Ready for Week 5? (the letter and the reply both written)	

Worksheet 5.1 - The memory harvest

The good (the times I would keep)	The ordinary (the way they were, day to day)	The difficult (the arguments, the faults, the things I wish were different; they were a whole person)

Worksheet 5.2 - The legacy list

What of them I carry (phrases, habits, values, skills, tastes, jokes)	Where it shows in me	One thing I will do this month because they would have

Worksheet 5.3 - The objects

Their things	Keep (and where it will live)	Give (to whom)	Let go	Not yet

Worksheet 5.4 - The rituals

The next date that matters (birthday, anniversary, holiday)	What I will do, with whom, where	What I will do afterwards

A small regular ritual (weekly or monthly)	When	What it is for

Weekly review

Memories written, and the one I had nearly lost	
The legacy item I will act on this month	
Objects: how many kept, given, let go, not yet; how it felt	
The ritual planned, and the date	
The second avoided item: done?	
Average heaviest moment this week, against Week 1	
Ready for Week 6?	

Worksheet 6.1 - The roles they held

What they did (practical, social, emotional)	I will learn it	Someone else will (who)	It stops	Notes

Worksheet 6.2 - The pleasure schedule, Week 6

Day	Planned pleasure (small, specific, with whom)	Predicted enjoyment (0-10)	Actual (0-10)	Guilt (0-10)	Notes
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Worksheet 6.3 - The identity questions

Who was I, with them, in three words	
Who am I now, in three words, honestly	
What did I give up or set aside for them, or for their illness, that I could take back	
What did I never do because of them, that I might now	
What would they say about the life I am living	
One thing I want the next year to contain that this one has not	

Weekly review

Roles: how many learned, handed on, stopped	
Pleasures planned and done; predicted against actual, on average	
The guilt, and whether it changed across the week	
The identity question that was hardest	
The third avoided item	
Average heaviest moment this week, against Week 1	
Ready for Week 7?	

Worksheet 7.1 - The map of the people

Who has been there (and how)	Who has gone quiet (and what I think happened)	Who could be there if I asked	Who I have been avoiding

Worksheet 7.2 - The things people say

What they say	What I feel	What I will say back
"How are you?"		
"They're in a better place" / "It was for the best"		
"At least..." (they had a good life; you had the years; you can have another)		
"You're so strong" / "You're doing so well"		
"Let me know if you need anything"		
"It's been a year now" / "Are you still...?"		
Nothing at all; they change the subject		

Worksheet 7.3 - The ask

The person	The specific request (what, when, how long)	Asked on	What they said	What happened

Weekly review

The people who have been there, counted	
The sentence I most needed a reply to, and the reply	
The ask: made? Answered?	
Grieving differently: who in the family, and what I understood	
The fourth avoided item	
Average heaviest moment this week, against Week 1	
Ready for Week 8?	

Worksheet 8.1 - The calendar of firsts

Date	What it is	Who I will be with	What I will do	The day after

Worksheet 8.2 - The bad-day card

This is a wave, not a verdict. It is about _____. It will pass.	
Feet on the floor. Four in, six out, five times.	
The next small thing: _____	
Today I will still: get up, eat, go outside, tell _____	
I do not decide anything big today.	
If I have thoughts of not wanting to be here, I call _____ (988 / 116 123 / my doctor) today.	
Tonight: the log. Tomorrow: the ritual, or a pleasure from the list.	

Worksheet 8.3 - The eight-week review

	Week 1	Week 8
Average heaviest moment (0-10)		
Grief self-check total (Worksheet 3.2)		
Nights of five hours or more, out of seven		
Avoided items, out of the original list		
People I talked to honestly this week		
Pleasures done this week		
The thought that hurts most, and belief in it (0-100)		

What has changed in eight weeks	
What has not	
The week that helped most	
Whether the grief is moving (yes / not sure / no; if no, Chapter 11)	

Worksheet 8.4 - The letter to myself, to open in a year

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Seal it, date it, and put it with the things you keep.

Weekly review

The calendar of firsts: how many dates, and the first one coming	
The bad-day card copied and kept where	
Avoided items done, and dates for the rest	
The self-check, then and now	
The weekly minimum I have chosen	
The letter written and sealed	
Whether I need more than this book, and what I will do about it	

Worksheet 12.1 - My help plan

My doctor (name, number)	
The crisis line for where I live	
The person I will call on a bad day	
The bereavement counsellor or hospice service nearest me (found on)	
The group for my kind of loss (found on)	
The sign that would mean I need more than this book (from the list above)	
What I will do, the same day, if I see it	

Blank grief log

Day	Heaviest moment (0-10)	The feeling	What set it off	What helped	Sleep (hours)

Blank balanced view

The thought that hurts	Guilt / anger / if-only / other	Belief (0-100)	Evidence for (facts; what I knew then)	Evidence against; what I would tell a friend	The balanced view	Belief now

Blank avoided-item record

The item	Fear before (0-10)	What I did	Fear at the peak	Fear after	What actually happened

Blank pleasure schedule

Day	Planned pleasure	Predicted (0-10)	Actual (0-10)	Guilt (0-10)	Notes

Blank letter and reply

The letter:

The reply, in their voice:

The twelve-week tracker

Week	Average heaviest moment (0-10)	Nights of 5+ hours	Basics kept (days)	Pleasures done	People talked to	Ritual done	Notes
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							
11							
12							